



ICPSR 37679

Radicalization on the Internet: Virtual Extremism in the United States, 2015-2017

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Questionnaire for Online Extremism Survey
Data Wave 1



National Institute of Justice
Data Resources Program

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Radicalization on the Internet and Online Extremism

Hello, we are researching the expression of extremist and hateful opinions on the web, and we would like to invite you to participate in our study. The following information is provided to inform you of the research project that will be conducted by Dr. Thomas Ratliff, Dr. James Hawdon, Dr. David Snow, and others.

PURPOSE OF THE STUDY: The purpose of this study is to investigate the use of social networking sites (SNS) among Americans and if they have seen or heard materials that express hateful or extremely negative attitudes towards people or groups. We are interested to see if the use of SNS influences if people see these materials and if seeing such materials are related to people's levels of trust, online activities, and other experiences.

PROCEDURES: You are being asked to complete an online questionnaire about SNS use and extremist materials online. If you decide to participate, completing the interview will require about ten minutes. You will not be identified in any way, and your answers will remain confidential. There will be no way anyone will find out who you are or how you answered these questions. All results of this research will be reported in aggregate form so no individuals could be identified.

RISKS: This survey will ask you questions about your online experiences. It will also ask you questions about your levels of trust in various people and institutions. The questions are not about sensitive topics, although some items will ask if you have seen or been a target of harassing materials online. However, we believe this research poses no risks to you.

BENEFITS: There is a societal benefit of increasing the understanding the extent to which hateful and extremist materials are online, how people respond when they see these materials, and how these materials influences individuals' levels of trust in others.

COMPENSATION: There is no compensation for participation in this project.

FREEDOM TO WITHDRAW: By agreeing to participate in the study, you do not waive any rights that you may have regarding access to and disclosure of your records. Your participation in this study is completely voluntary. If you choose to participate, your responses will be held in confidence. You are free to withdraw at any time without penalty. In addition, you also understand that you may skip any question that you do not want to answer. Finally, if the results of this study were to be written for publication, no identifying information will be used.

APPROVAL OF RESEARCH: This study has been reviewed and approved by Arkansas State University's Institutional Review Board (IRB). The IRB has determined that this study meets the ethical obligations required by federal law and University policies. If you have questions or concerns regarding this study please contact the Investigator or Advisor. If you have any questions regarding your rights as a research subject, please contact the **Director of Research Compliance** at 870-972-2694.

PARTICIPANTS RESPONSIBILITY: You are responsible for answering the questions you choose to answer. If you have any questions or concerns about this research, please contact Dr. James Hawdon at 540-231-7476. You can also contact Dr. Hawdon at hawdonj@vt.edu or by mail at Center for Peace Studies and Violence Prevention, Virginia Tech, 205a Norris Hall, 495 Old Turner St. Blacksburg, VA 24061.

PARTICIPANTS CONSENT: I have read and understood the Informed Consent Statement and conditions of this project. By clicking on the link below, I hereby acknowledge the above, I assert I am 18 years of age or older, and I give my voluntary consent for participation in this project.

LINK (RESPONDENT BEGINS SURVEY) EXIT (SURVEY TERMINATES)

1. Are you
 1. male
 2. female
2. In what year were you born?
3. Were you born in the U.S.? (yes no)
4. In which state do you currently live? Choose (from an alphabetical list of states + Washington, D.C.)
5. Was either of your parents born outside the U.S.?
6. How would you describe where you live?
 1. a large city (over 250,000)
 2. a medium-size city (50,000 – 250,000)
 3. a small city or town (Under 50,000)
 4. a suburb near a city
 5. open country or a rural area
7. Are you currently:
 1. Living alone
 2. Married or living with a partner, no children in the home
 3. Single parent
 4. Married or living with a partner, children in the home
 5. Living with parents
 6. Other family type (e.g. living with roommates)
8. Which is the highest level of education you have achieved?
 1. Less than a High School degree

2. High School degree
3. Some college
4. A college degree
5. A master's degree, professional degree or higher

9. What is your main occupation?

1. I'm in school
2. I'm in a paid, full-time job
3. I'm in a paid, part-time job
4. I'm unemployed/ looking for a job
5. I'm unemployed/ not looking for a job

If A, ask 9a

9a. If you are in school, are you currently in:

1. High school
2. A technical or trade school
3. College or University
4. Other school

10. What is your race? Indicate one or more races that you consider yourself to be.

1. White
2. Black or African American
3. Hispanic
4. Asian
5. Two or more races
6. Some other race
7. REFUSE

11. In the past 3 months, which of the following services have you used? Choose all that apply.

- a. Facebook
- b. YouTube
- c. Twitter
- d. (IRC-Galleria) only to Finnish version
- e. Google+
- f. Habbo
- g. Wkipedia
- h. MySpace
- i. Ning

- j. MyLife
- k. Tumblr
- l. LiveJournal
- m. Newspaper message boards
- n. General message boards
- o. Image boards (e.g. 4chan)
- p. Instant messengers (e.g. Windows Live Messenger)
- q. Online role-playing games (e.g. World of Warcraft, Runescape)
- r. Photo sharing services (e.g. Instagram, Pinterest, Flickr)
- s. Blogs
- t. Skype
- u. Anonymous network (e.g. Tor, Freenet, I2P)
- v. E-mail

12. Approximately how many hours per day do you use the Internet?

- 1. Less than one hour per day
- 2. One or two hours per day
- 3. Two to five hours per day
- 4. More than five hours per day

13. In the past 3 months, have you seen hateful or degrading writings or speech online that attacked certain groups of people or individuals?

- 1. yes
- 2. no

14. In the past 3 months, have you seen or heard any materials online that expressed negative views about any group because of the group's race, nationality, ethnicity, sexual orientation, gender, political views, immigrant status, or religion? yes no

If no, skip to #20

15. Thinking of the most recent time when you saw or heard negative views expressed about a group, how would you describe those views? (check all that apply)

- 1. They advocated violence against the group
- 2. They used stereotypes to describe the group
- 3. They blamed the group for their problems.
- 4. They blamed the group for the nation's problems.
- 5. They advocated hatred of the group
- 6. They called for others to discriminate against the group

16. Did the negative views that you saw or heard online pertain to one or more of the following? (Check all that apply)

- 1. Ethnicity or race
- 2. Nationality or immigrant status
- 3. Sexual orientation

4. Religious conviction/belief
5. Political views
6. Sex/Gender
7. Other, what?

17. Please indicate on which of the following services you saw or heard these views. Choose all that apply.

1. Facebook
2. YouTube
3. Twitter
4. Google+
5. Habbo
6. Wikipedia
7. MySpace
8. Ning
9. MyLife
10. Tumblr
11. LiveJournal
12. Newspaper message boards
13. General message boards
14. Image boards (e.g. 4chan)
15. Instant messengers (e.g. Windows Live Messenger)
16. Online role-playing games (e.g. World of Warcraft, Runescape)
17. Photo sharing services (e.g. Instagram, Pinterest, Flickr)
18. Blogs
19. Home pages
20. Pop-up sites
21. Skype
22. Anonymous network (e.g. Tor, Freenet, I2P)
23. E-mail

18. How did you end up on this site?

1. I deliberately found my way
2. I got the link to the site from a friend or acquaintance of mine
3. I got there by accident

19. In your opinion, how disturbing was this material? Please assess on a scale from 1–5, when 1 = extremely disturbing and 5= not at all disturbing.

20. How frequently do you see material online that expresses negative views toward some group? Would you say

1. I never see this type of material
2. I see this type of material very infrequently
3. I see this type of material occasionally
4. I see this type of material frequently

21. Have you ever personally been the target of hateful or degrading material online?

1. Yes
2. No (If no, Skip to 23)

22. To which of the following did the hateful or degrading material that targeted you pertain?

Choose all relevant options.

- a. Ethnicity or race
- b. Nationality
- c. Sexual orientation
- d. Religious conviction/belief
- e. Political views
- f. Disability
- g. Sex/Gender
- h. Appearance
- i. None of the above mentioned

23. When you're on a social networking site, how often do you see people being hateful?

1. Never
2. Only once in a while
3. Sometimes
4. Frequently

24. Overall, in your experience, are people mostly kind or mostly unkind to one another on social networking sites?

1. Kind
2. Unkind
3. It depends

25. How often do you see people using language, images or humor on social networking sites that you find offensive?

1. Never
2. Only once in a while
3. Sometimes
4. Frequently

26. When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often do you tell the person who is being offensive to stop?

1. Never

2. Only once in a while
3. Sometimes
4. Frequently

27. When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often do you defend the person or group being attacked?

1. Never
2. Only once in a while
3. Sometimes
4. Frequently

28. When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often do you ignore what is being said?

1. Never
2. Only once in a while
3. Sometimes
4. Frequently

29. When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often do you join in the mean or offensive behavior?

1. Never
2. Only once in a while
3. Sometimes
4. Frequently

30. When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often have others told the person who is being offensive to stop?

1. Never
2. Only once in a while
3. Sometimes
4. Frequently

31. When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often have others defended the person or group being attacked?

1. Never
2. Only once in a while
3. Sometimes
4. Frequently

32. When people on social networking sites are being mean or offensive, how often have joined in the mean or offensive behavior?

1. Never
2. Only once in a while
3. Sometimes

4. Frequently

33. Please answer the following questions using a scale from 1–10, where 1 = not very true of me, and 10 = very true of me.

I have high self-esteem.

34. I enjoy taking risks.

35. I find it easier to talk about private things online when others don't know who I am.

Would you say that the following people can be trusted, or that you can't be too careful in dealing with these people? Assess on a scale from 1–10, where 1 = you can't be too careful and 10 = can be fully trusted.

36. People in general

37. Your work or school colleagues

38. People met only online

39. The people who run your local government

40. The people who run congress

41. The police

42. The president

43. The people who run large corporations

44. The people who run financial institutions such as banks

45. How many friends do you have on Facebook (number)

46. How many friends do you have with whom you can discuss intimate and personal matters (number)

47. How many of these close friends do you interact with only online?

1. almost none of them
2. a few, but most of my close friends I also see offline
3. most of my close friends I only see online, but I do have close offline friends

4. almost all of my close friends are online friends

How close do you feel to each of the following? Please indicate on a scale from 1 to 5 where 1 = not at all close and 5 = very close.

48. Family

49. Friends

50. Your neighbors

51. An online community to which you belong

52. A religious community

53. A club or recreational group

54. In your own opinion, have you been a target/victim of an online crime?
(yes no) If no, skip to 56

55. Which crime was this?

1. Slander or defamation of your character
2. Coercion or a threat of violence
3. Identity theft
4. Fraud
5. Sexual harassment
6. Other, which?

56. Below you can give feedback to the authors of the questionnaire. Were any questions ambiguous or hard to understand? Did you feel like some important answer options were missing? All feedback is very welcome!